ASSEMBLY POLLS 2022

GOA

GOA GETS A PARTY OF PARTIES

The TMC's entry is the big news in the Goa election. Elsewhere, the mix 'n match of state politics continues even as the BJP tries to stave off anti-incumbency

BY KIRAN D. TARE

On January 7, Mahua Moitra, the Trinamool Congress (TMC) poll in-charge for Goa, proposed a grand alliance of opposition parties against the ruling BJP for the coming assembly election in the state. The alliance, she said, should consist of the TMC, its ally Maharashtrawadi Gomantak Party (MGP), the Congress and its ally Goa Forward Party (GFP), and even the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP). Moitra's idea did create a buzz but failed to impress the parties concerned.

The TMC's re-entry after a decade in Goa has rapidly changed the political scene in the state. What earlier looked like a straight contest between the BJP and Congress has turned into a four-cornered battle. The formation of new alliances and the end of old tie-ups have been the highlight of this election. The TMC made its presence felt with a grand surprise in October last year when it inducted state Congress president Luizinho Faleiro, a former chief minister of the state. This was followed by the entry of several prominent individuals, including authors and an environmental activist. TMC chief Mamata Banerjee has toured Goa twice, and the party had also extended a hand of

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KONKANI SLANT
Mamata meets the locals in Goa